practices. Smoking restrict the blood supply to the growing foetus and soulmates oxygen and nutrient delivery and waste removal. Smokers tend to eat less nutritious food during their pregnancy than do non-smokers which in turn impairs foetal nutrition. A positive relationship exist between sudden infant death syndrome (SIDS) and both cigarette smoking during pregnancy and postnatal exposure to passive smoke. Smoking during pregnancy may even harm the intellectual and behavioural development of the child later in life. Infants of mother who chew tobacco also have lower weight and higher rates of foetal death than infants born to women who do not use tobacco.

e) Environmental contaminants

Infants and young children of pregnant women exposed to environmental containment such as lead and mercury show signs of impaired cognitive development.



In order to prepare body for birth, it produces a hormone called relaxin which softens your ligaments. This softening helps your baby pass through your pelvis during labour.

f) Vitamin mineral megadoses

The pregnant women who is trying to eat well may mistakenly assume that more is better when it comes to vitamin - mineral supplements. This is simply not true, many vitamin are toxic when taken in excess, and the minerals are even more so, some at levels not far above recommendations.

g) Caffeine

Caffeine crosses the placenta, and the developing foetus has a limited ability to metabolize it. For this reason, pregnant women may wonder whether they should give up coffee, tea, and colas because of their caffeine contents. Research studies have not proved that caffeine (even in high doses) causes birth defects in human infants (as it does in animal), but limited evidence suggests that moderate - to - heavy use may lower infant birth weight.

h) Weight loss dieting

Weight loss dieting, even for short periods, is hazardous during pregnancy. Low - carbohydrate diets or fats that causes ketosis deprive the foetal brain of needed glucose and may impair its development. Such diets are also likely to lack other nutrients vital to foetal growth. Regardless of prepregnancy weight, pregnant women should never intentionally lose weight.

i) Sugar substitutes

Artificial sweeteners have been extensively investigated and found to be safe for use during pregnancy. (Women with phenylketonuria should not use aspartame). It would be prudent for pregnant women to use sweeteners in moderation and within an nutritious and well balanced diet.



Activity : 3

Prepare a low cost iron rich diet for a pregnant women

2.2 Nutrition in lactation

Nutritional link between the mother and child continues even after birth. Born baby depends for some period solely on breast milk for their existence. During the first two or three days after birth, a small amount of Colostrum is secreted. The amount of milk produced corresponds either to the productive capacity of the mother or the nutritional requirements of the infant. Many factors influence milk production, nutritional status being one of them. Nutritional requirements

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